

Erlang Ecosystem Foundation

Annual General Meeting

December 2023

Chair's Report



This is the 4th Annual Report for the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation.

Genesis

The Foundation officially filed its articles of incorporation as a California Nonprofit Public Benefit Corporation on Jan 19th, 2019 and it was duly registered as such on Jan 23rd, 2019. As of May 29th, 2020 we also received formal approval from the IRS as a US 501(c)(3) not-for-profit under federal tax laws.

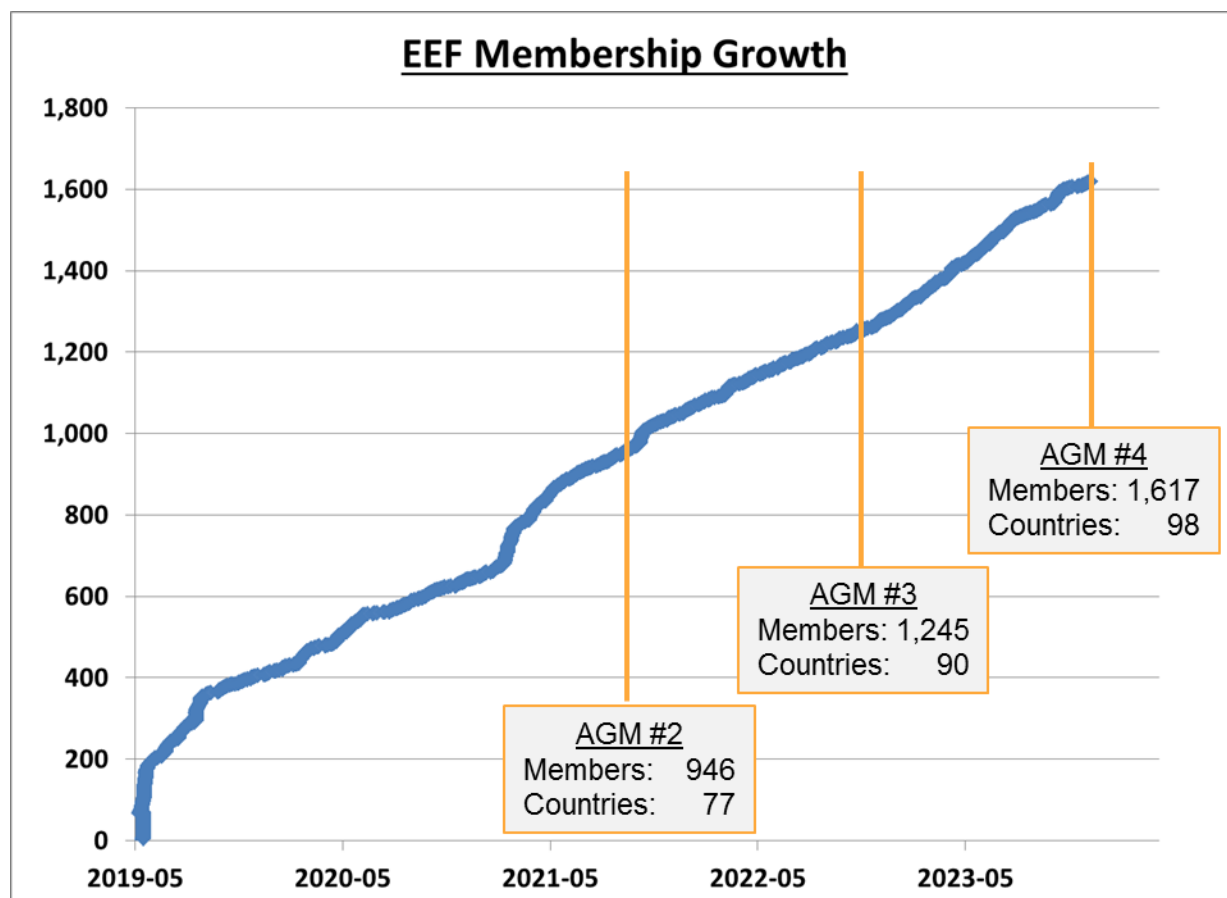
Our Members

Per our charter and bylaws, we are a community benefit organization open to all persons interested in the well-being of the BEAM languages and the developers using them.

Current Members List

Summary Keyword search Advanced search Saved searches									
Level	Total	Active	Renewal overdue	Lapsed	Pending			New in last	
					New	Renewal	Level change	7 days	30 days
Annual Supporting Membership	148	145	17	-	3	-	-	-	-
Basic Membership	1422	1422	-	-	-	-	-	5	13
Board	6	6	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Fellow	2	2	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Lifetime Supporting Membership	21	20	-	-	1	-	-	-	-
Managing and Contributing	18	18	4	-	-	-	-	-	-
Total	1617	1613	21	-	4	-	-	5	13

As of the time of this report we have 1,617 members. This is an increase of 372 members or a CARG 28% growth since the last AGM (over the last 13 months). The community has been growing at a relatively consistent rate both during Covid and in the post-Covid environments (see graph below).



Rank	Country
1	United States
2	Brazil
3	Germany
4	United Kingdom
5	India
6	Canada
7	Sweden
8	Poland
9	Japan
10	Spain
11	Argentina
12	China
13	Italy
14	France
15	Netherlands
16	Australia
17	Portugal
18	Russian Federation
19	Kenya
20	Switzerland

The ranking table above remains quite stable reflecting the distribution of countries population size, density of software engineers and the historic centers of Erlang's adoption around the Baltic Region and Elixir's start in South America. The biggest mover in the last period has been Germany that moved up two places. (This may be as a result of Erlang and Elixir events that happened in Germany) .

Membership now covers 98 countries up from 90 countries since the last AGM. The new countries are Barbados; Cameroon; Croatia; Georgia; Guatemala; Nepal; São Tomé & Príncipe; and Tunisia.

In regards to expanding the membership, we will continue to focus on outreach and inclusivity. Several of our working groups, especially the Marketing and Education, Training & Adoption WGs have charters and have allocated budgets to promote diversity.

Members with an interest in helping with diversity are encouraged to reach out to these two working groups.

Our Sponsors

We are grateful to our sponsors for their financial support. They are instrumental in putting the Foundation on a sound financial footing and allow us to invest in community development and future growth. At the moment we have 31 sponsors.



The Sponsorship WG continues its focus on increasing our outreach to companies and other not-for-profits in the software development space.

Probably the biggest concern that the board has over the last reporting period is how to grow the number of sponsors. We believe that the uncertainty caused by inflation and interest rate hikes and general worries about a possible recession made companies more conservative and cautious in 2023. Fund raising has not been as successful as we planned.

Recently, however, the business mood appears to be improving and we want to re-energize our fund-raising.

Any members working for companies who are heavy users of Elixir and Erlang are encouraged to broker relationships with their executives and the Sponsorship WG. We are very interested in creating a virtuous circle of mutual interest and increasing the rate of the community's expansion.

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The Working Groups

At the moment, there are 13 chartered Working Groups within the EEF. Since the last AGM we have added the 'Libraries & Frameworks' Working Group.

All current Working Groups are:

- Marketing
- Security
- Build and Packaging
- Fellowship
- Sponsorship
- Observability
- Education, Training & Adoption
- Embedded Systems
- Infrastructure
- Language Interoperability
- External Process Communication, Interoperability & Robustness (EPC)
- Machine Learning
- Libraries & Frameworks

The present WGs are interested in more active members joining them and any member with a specific interest is encouraged to get involved

The board continues to be open to the chartering of new WGs from members who are passionate about a specific area and are willing to self-organize.

The Board

The board has held 92 meetings since the founding meeting on Thursday Feb 21, 2019.

In March and April 2023 we held our Cohort A re-election process which led to one new board member, Amos King, being elected. The board warmly thanks the departing board member, Fred Hebert, for his time serving on the board.

The following are the major regulatory compliance milestones that occurred between the 3rd and 4th AGMs:

- 2023-09-15; 2020 & 2021 RRF-1 forms filed with CA DoJ
- 2023-11-13; 2022 IRS 990 and CA FTB 199 filed
- 2023-11-19; 2022 RRF-1 form filed with CA DoJ

Pursuant to the EEF Bylaws the following major actions were taken:

- 2023-04 Board elections by the voting members for cohort A per Section 5.5 & 14.8
(Francesco Cesarini, Amos King, Sebastian Strollo and Alistair Woodman were duly elected)
- 2023-05 President & Secretary/Treasurer elections by the board per Section 5.5.1 & 14.8
(Sebastian Strollo (Secretary/Treasurer) and Alistair Woodman (President) were duly re-elected)
- 2023-11 The remote 4th AGM was scheduled for 2023-12-21 per Section 3.12 & 14.8

Since the last AGM, the board also approved grants and stipends requested by various WGs for following areas:

Approved Outreach Funds

• \$ 4,000	Sponsor Erlang Forums	Feb 2023
• \$ 2,000	Writing secure Elixir tutorial	Mar 2023
• \$ 6,000	Exercism syllabus for Gleam	Apr 2023
• \$ 1,000	ElixirConf Africa sponsorship	May 2023
• \$ 500	Travel stipend	Aug 2023
• \$ 3,000	SpawnFest Sponsorship	Aug 2023
• \$ 900	OpenID Foundation membership	Aug 2023
• \$ 338	Sponsor student tickets for Elixir Foraleza Conf 2023	Sep 2023

Approved Development Funds

• \$25,000	Set-theoretic Type Checker	Nov 2022
• \$ 950	BLAS Library, phase 1	Nov 2022
• \$ 4,000	OTP Build System improvements	Feb 2023
• \$ 2,500	Apache Arrow integration	Mar 2023
• \$12,000	TensorFlow Lite API integration	Mar 2023
• \$ 3,000	BLAS Library, phase 2	Apr 2023
• \$40,000	JIT for ARM32	Jul 2023
• \$15,600	OpenID Connect client	Aug 2023
• \$15,000	OpenTelemetry	Dec 2023

With regards to all our diversity programs which are now in their 5 year, we proud that we have supported 600 individuals to attend events and conferences (mostly remotely due to Covid). The individuals can from a very diverse set of countries (see below).

Algeria	Argentina	Australia	Brazil	Canada
China	Colombia	Croatia	Czech Republic	Finland
France	Germany	Greece	Hungary	India
Indonesia	Iran	Italy	Japan	Kenya
Kyrgyzstan	Madagascar	Mexico	Montenegro	Morocco
Nigeria	Pakistan	Portugal	Russia	Rwanda
Saudi Arabia	Scotland	South Korea	Spain	Sweden
Taiwan	Togo	Turkey	Uganda	UK
UAE	Uruguay	USA	Zambia	

Starting in February 2021, the board also approved an ongoing budget for an external marcom agency. The resources, Nayra & El Maizal Coop, are based in Argentina and have been providing marketing communications services to the Marketing and Sponsorship WGs as well as the board.

Ongoing funding has also continued to the Infrastructure and Marketing WGs to improve the general IT infrastructure and build out the **erlef.org** website. The following features are the result of these ongoing funding

- Basic working group management tools
- Working Group report support
 - Backed by git, we'll be utilizing this abstraction for other forthcoming features
- Erlef.org email for members program
- Slack invite support for erlef, erlanger, and lfe slack
- Basic calendar integration
- Conference perk program for members
- Misc. additions and improvements
 - Security audit and improvements
 - Community page
 - Public records page
 - Fellows gallery
 - Public site analytics
 - Internal error logging and alerts
 - Object storage support for media uploads
 - General UI/UX improvements
- (in development) Job Board

Motions to the AGM:

Motion: The President and Secretary/Treasurer are recommending that the voting members ratify the actions of the Board and Officers of the EEF as being in the interests of the EEF and in accordance with the Bylaws.

Motion: The Secretary/Treasurer and President are recommending that the voting members ratify the accompanying 2023 Financial Report Document.

Looking Forward

The board is looking at several avenues for activities over the next 6-to-12 months.

1) Improved sponsorship fundraising:

All members are encouraged to get in touch with the Sponsorship WG if they are aware of companies that should be approached for sponsorship.

2) How to get more involvement:

Feedback and suggestions from the members in this regard are welcome, especially if we can get insight about regional or country specific opportunities.

3) More directed funding:

The board is asking the WGs to prioritize projects that they feel that the EEF should be supporting

4) Spending money:

We intend to encourage more WG activity..

Best Regards

Alistair Woodman
Chair and President of the EEF